

FIFA WORLD CUP 2026 · GROUP G · MATCH 64 · MATCHDAY 3

New Zealand vs Belgium

Friday, June 26, 2026 · Kickoff 11:00 PM ET / 8:00 PM PT / 11:00 AM MYT (Jun 27) · BC Place, Vancouver, BC. Pre-match analysis for entertainment purposes only — not investment advice.



New Zealand

FIFA #86 · 1 pt · GD -2
· Must win

VS

Belgium

FIFA #9 · 2 pts · GD 0 ·
Win to advance



Report updated: June 26, 2026. Exchange rate basis: ECB reference **1 EUR = 1.08 USD** (June 25, 2026). DraftKings / FanDuel / bet365 odds verified as of June 26, 2026. Starting XIs, score paths, and betting allocations are **Assumed/Inference** unless officially confirmed. Confirm all prices and lines at your sportsbook before wagering.

Key Conclusions

Belgium Heavy Favorite

~74% implied win probability (de-vigged).
DraftKings BEL -475 / NZL +1300.

Central Score Path

Belgium 2-0. Red Devils need a win; NZ must chase but lack firepower (1 goal in 2 games).

BTTS Lean: Yes

NZ scored in both group games (Wood, Just). Belgium blank vs Iran but market prices BTTS Yes.

Group G Drama

Egypt lead on 4 pts. Belgium & Iran on 2. NZ bottom on 1 — simultaneous kickoffs with Egypt vs Iran.

Verified: Fixture, Venue, Referee (Makhadmeh)

Verified: Group G Standings & MD1-2 Results

Verified: Multi-book Odds (Jun 26)

Assumed: Predicted Lineups & Score Thesis

Assumed: Player Market Values (Transfermarkt)

Concentrated Betting Plan

Budget: \$100 entertainment cap · **\$2 per unit** · 50 units total. Score thesis: Belgium finally convert dominance into goals with elimination pressure; New Zealand forced forward after two draws leave them bottom, but quality gap and Ngoy suspension favor a multi-goal Belgium win.

⚠ **Concentrated plans increase variance and may lose the entire entertainment budget.**

Score Thesis Summary

Market baseline: Belgium win ~74% (DraftKings -475). Belgium dominated Iran (23 shots, 0 goals) and drew Egypt 1-1 — finishing has been the issue, not chance creation. New Zealand drew Iran 2-2 but lost 3-1 to Egypt; Chris Wood and Elijah Just have scored. Nathan Ngoy suspended (DOGSO red vs Iran). **Central path:** Belgium 2-0. Alternative: Belgium 2-1 if NZ counter via Wood aerial threat. Roof likely closed (rain); minimal weather impact on tempo.

\$60

Core — Belgium -2.5 Asian Handicap @ +115 to +120

30 units · Thesis: must-win Belgium vs desperate but outclassed NZ; Tunisia friendly (5-0) shows ceiling when attack clicks.

30 u

Min odds: +110 · Cancel if: Lukaku or De Bruyne rested; Doku illness recurs; handicap moves to -1.5 or shorter.

\$25

Adjacent — Over 2.5 Goals @ -145

12.5 units · NZ must attack; Belgium should create volume. Combined 4 goals in NZ's two group games.

12.5 u

Min odds: -150 · Cancel if: Belgium revert to cautious 0-0 approach; heavy rotation confirmed.

\$15

Differential — Correct Score Belgium 2-0 @ +450 to +500

7.5 units · Matches central thesis; Belgium kept 1 clean sheet (vs Iran) but NZ attack limited outside Wood/Just.

7.5 u

Min odds: +425 · **Cancel if:** BTTS Yes drops below -120 (signals NZ goal threat priced in).

Pre-Purchase Check

Condition	Action
Handicap line moves to -1.5 or Belgium -1.0	Reduce core allocation; multi-goal margin less certain at shorter line.
Doku confirmed OUT; Lukaku starts on bench	Halve Over 2.5 stake; suspend 2-0 correct score.
Egypt-Iran early goal changes tactics	If Egypt lead, Belgium may settle for narrow win — drop -2.5 core.
Odds below stated minimums	Do not force — mark selection Not recommended.

Referee & Environment Impact

Referee: Adham Makhadmeh (Jordan)

Verified: FIFA appointed Jordanian team led by Makhadmeh (FIFA ref since 2013). Also officiated Spain vs Cape Verde (MD1). Ngoy's Iran red was by Dario Herrera (Argentina), not Makhadmeh.

Score adjustment: NO CHANGE — moderate card profile expected; unlikely to disrupt Belgium rhythm.

Match Environment

Venue: BC Place, Vancouver — 54,500 capacity, FieldTurf, retractable roof. **Weather (Environment Canada, Jun 25):** Periods of rain, high 17°C (63°F), evening ~16°C (61°F), humidity ~82%, SSE wind 20 km/h gusting 40 near water.

Roof status: **Assumed/Inference:** Roof likely **closed** given rain forecast; playing surface covered regardless. BC Place FAQ confirms seated guests remain covered rain or shine.

Score adjustment: NO CHANGE — climate-controlled bowl neutralizes rain; slight UP total if NZ press high when trailing.

Factor	Evidence	Direction	Confidence
Retractable roof (closed)	Rain forecast; FIFA broadcast environment	NO CHANGE	Medium
FieldTurf surface	BC Place standard for World Cup	Neutral tempo	Medium
Belgium motivation	Win needed; 2 draws, 1 goal scored	UP favorite scoring	High
NZ desperation	Must win; Wood/Just in form	UP total goals tail	Medium
Ngoy suspension	DOGSO red vs Iran — Theate/De Winter likely in	UP NZ counter tail	Low

Event Background

Group G Context (After MD2)

Team	P	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts
Egypt	2	1	1	0	4	2	+2	4
Iran	2	0	2	0	2	2	0	2
Belgium	2	0	2	0	1	1	0	2
New Zealand	2	0	1	1	3	5	-2	1

Egypt lead after first-ever World Cup win (3-1 vs NZ). Belgium drew Egypt 1-1 and Iran 0-0 (Ngoy sent off). NZ drew Iran 2-2. Final MD3 kickoffs simultaneous: Egypt vs Iran (Lumen Field) and NZ vs Belgium (BC Place).

Previous Results & Stakes

MD1: Belgium 1–1 Egypt (Seattle); Iran 2–2 New Zealand (LA)

MD2: Belgium 0–0 Iran (LA, Ngoy red 66'); Egypt 3–1 New Zealand (Vancouver)

Stakes: Belgium win likely secures knockout berth. New Zealand must win and need Egypt-Iran result help. No senior H2H between these nations — first competitive meeting (2008 Olympics: Belgium 1-0 NZ, not senior).

Team Overview

New Zealand (All Whites)

Third World Cup appearance (1982, 2010, 2026) under **Darren Bazeley**. Captain **Chris Wood** (record caps & goals) and Tommy Smith are first Kiwis at two men's World Cups. Wood returned from knee surgery in April; scored twice since.

Style: Compact 4-2-3-1, direct play through Wood aerially, Just/McCowatt creativity. **Risk:** Conceded 5 in 2 games; travel across North America.

Belgium (Red Devils)

13th World Cup under **Rudi Garcia**. Golden generation tail: Courtois, De Bruyne, Lukaku (4th WC each), Witsel. Dominated Iran but failed to score; Beiranvand made 11 saves.

Style: 4-2-3-1 possession, De Bruyne orchestration, Trossard/Doku width. **Missing:** Nathan Ngoy (suspended), Zeno Debast (leg injury since MD1). Doku missed Iran through illness — expected back.

Category	New Zealand	Belgium
FIFA Ranking	#86 (Verified, Transfermarkt)	#9 (Verified, Bracket Research)
Squad Value	~\$30M (€27.55m TM)	~\$591M (€547.5m TM)
World Cup History	3 appearances; 0 wins (2010: 3 draws)	13 appearances; 3rd place 2018
H2H	No senior competitive meetings (Verified)	
Tournament Form	D 2-2, L 1-3	D 1-1, D 0-0
xG (ESPN)	1.24 avg for / 1.69 against	1.57 avg for / 0.85 against

Predicted Starters & Tactics

Assumed/Inference Lineups projected from FotMob, Sports Mole, and ESPN squad data.

Confirm ~1 hour before kickoff.

BC Place · ~61°F · Rain · Roof assumed closed

NZL 4-2-3-1 vs BEL 4-2-3-1



Key absences & subs (Assumed): Nathan Ngoy (BEL, suspended — DOGSO vs Iran). Zeno Debast (BEL, leg injury). Jeremy Doku (BEL, illness vs Iran — expected available).

Likely BEL subs: Saelemaekers, De Ketelaere, Witsel, Onana. Likely NZL subs: Barbarouses, Waine, Bindon, Garbett.

Tactical Question	Watch For	Betting Implication
Can Belgium finish?	23 shots, 0 goals vs Iran; xG 1.57 avg.	If early goal, -2.5 and Over 2.5 strengthen.
Wood aerial threat	5'10" striker vs Theate/Mechele on corners.	BTTS Yes tail if NZ score first set piece.
Ngoy absence	Theate slots in; Meunier/De Cuyper provide width.	Belgium defense still superior; minor NZ counter UP.
Game state after 60'	NZ must push if trailing; Belgium counter via Doku.	Late goals support Over 2.5 and -2.5 thesis.

Full Parallel Rosters

Squad data: Transfermarkt market values converted at 1 EUR = 1.08 USD (June 25, 2026).
Avatars show player initials.



New Zealand

MANAGER

DB

Darren Bazeley

Head Coach

Former NZ defender · 4-2-3-1 system

FORWARDS

CW

Chris Wood

34 · \$5.40M

#9 · ST · 191cm/81kg · Nottingham

Forest · Captain

KB

Kosta Barbarouses

36 · \$54K

#17 · ST · 171cm/68kg · Western Sydney

Wanderers

BW

Ben Waine

24 · \$3.24M

#18 · ST · 188cm/78kg · Port Vale

JR

Jesse Randall

23 · \$594K

#21 · ST · 178cm/72kg · Dundee United

MIDFIELDERS

JB

Joe Bell

27 · \$3.78M

#6 · CM · 182cm/76kg · Viking FK

MS

Marko Stamenic

26 · \$2.70M

#8 · CM · 185cm/75kg · Basel

EJ

Elijah Just

26 · \$2.70M

#11 · AM · 175cm/68kg · Motherwell · 2

WC goals

CM

Callum McCowatt

27 · \$540K

#20 · AM · 180cm/72kg · Silkeborg



Belgium

MANAGER

RG

Rudi Garcia

Head Coach

Former Napoli/Lille manager · 4-2-3-1

FORWARDS

RL

Romelu Lukaku

33 · \$21.6M

#9 · ST · 191cm/94kg · Napoli · 124 caps

LD

Jérémy Doku

23 · \$54.0M

#11 · LW · 173cm/70kg · Man City ·

Illness (MD2)

LT

Leandro Trossard

31 · \$27.0M

#10 · LW · 172cm/68kg · Arsenal

DL

Dodi Lukébakio

28 · \$21.6M

#14 · RW · 187cm/77kg · Benfica

CD

Charles De Ketelaere

25 · \$32.4M

#17 · AM · 192cm/78kg · Atalanta

AS

Alexis Saelemaekers

26 · \$21.6M

#22 · RW · 180cm/72kg · AC Milan

DM

Diego Moreira

21 · \$16.2M

#19 · LW · 180cm/72kg · Strasbourg

MF

Matias Fernandez-Pardo

21 · \$10.8M

#24 · ST · 185cm/78kg · Lille

MIDFIELDERS

LD

Kevin De Bruyne

34 · \$21.6M

SS

Sarpreet Singh

27 · \$540K

#10 · AM · 173cm/68kg · TSC Backa Topola

MG

Matt Garbett

24 · \$3.24M

#25 · CM · 180cm/74kg · Excelsior

BQ

Ben Old

23 · \$972K

#19 · AM · 176cm/70kg · Saint-Étienne

AR

Alex Rufer

27 · \$432K

#15 · CM · 180cm/72kg · Western Sydney

LB

Lachlan Bayliss

23 · \$972K

#14 · CM · 178cm/70kg · Newcastle Jets

RT

Ryan Thomas

31 · \$648K

#27 · CM · 175cm/68kg · PEC Zwolle

DEFENDERS

TB

Tyler Bindon

21 · \$3.78M

#4 · CB · 190cm/82kg · Nottingham Forest

FS

Finn Surman

22 · \$1.94M

#16 · CB · 190cm/80kg · Portland Timbers

MB

Michael Boxall

37 · \$162K

#5 · CB · 191cm/84kg · Minnesota United

LC

Liberato Cacace

28 · \$2.70M

#13 · LB · 182cm/74kg · Wrexham

YT

#7 · AM · 181cm/70kg · Napoli · 117 caps

YT

Youri Tielemans

28 · \$32.4M

#8 · CM · 177cm/72kg · Aston Villa · Captain

AD

Amadou Onana

24 · \$43.2M

#6 · DM · 195cm/82kg · Aston Villa

NR

Nicolas Raskin

25 · \$16.2M

#23 · DM · 187cm/78kg · Rangers

AW

Axel Witsel

37 · \$5.4M

#2 · DM · 186cm/81kg · Atlético Madrid · 136 caps

HV

Hans Vanaken

33 · \$10.8M

#20 · AM · 194cm/86kg · Club Brugge

DEFENDERS

AT

Arthur Theate

25 · \$21.6M

#4 · CB · 186cm/78kg · Eintracht Frankfurt

BM

Brandon Mechele

33 · \$10.8M

#3 · CB · 188cm/84kg · Club Brugge

KD

Koni De Winter

23 · \$27.0M

#16 · CB · 191cm/82kg · AC Milan

MD

Maxim De Cuyper

25 · \$21.6M

#5 · LB · 183cm/74kg · Brighton

TM

Thomas Meunier

34 · \$5.4M

#15 · RB · 190cm/78kg · Lille

TP

Tim Payne

32 · \$378K
#2 · RB · 179cm/74kg · Wellington Phoenix

TS

Tommy Smith

36 · \$324K
#26 · CB · 185cm/79kg · Braintree Town · 2nd WC

FD

Francis de Vries

27 · \$432K
#3 · LB · 185cm/76kg · Auckland FC

NP

Nando Pijnaker

25 · \$432K
#23 · CB · 188cm/82kg · Auckland FC

CE

Callan Elliot

27 · \$324K
#24 · RB · 178cm/72kg · Auckland FC

GOALKEEPERS

MG

Max Crocombe

32 · \$1.08M
#1 · GK · 190cm/84kg · Millwall

AP

Alex Paulsen

23 · \$540K
#12 · GK · 193cm/86kg · Bournemouth

MW

Michael Woud

27 · \$432K
#22 · GK · 196cm/88kg · Auckland FC

TC

Timothy Castagne

30 · \$10.8M
#21 · RB · 185cm/77kg · Fulham

JS

Joaquin Seys

21 · \$16.2M
#18 · LB · 178cm/72kg · Club Brugge

NN

Nathan Ngoy

22 · \$10.8M
#25 · CB · 191cm/82kg · Lille · SUSPENDED (DOGSO)

ZD

Zeno Debast

22 · \$30.2M
#13 · CB · 191cm/82kg · Sporting CP · OUT (leg injury)

GOALKEEPERS

TC

Thibaut Courtois

34 · \$16.2M
#1 · GK · 199cm/96kg · Real Madrid · 110 caps

SL

Senne Lammens

23 · \$37.8M
#12 · GK · 193cm/88kg · Man United

MP

Mike Penders

20 · \$27.0M
#13 · GK · 200cm/90kg · Chelsea

Odds & Probabilities

Odds aggregated from DraftKings, FanDuel, bet365, and RotoWire as of June 26, 2026. Implied probabilities de-vigged manually.

New Zealand +1300 to +1400 ~6–7% implied win probability		Draw +600 to +700 ~12–14% implied draw probability		Belgium –475 to –600 ~83% raw / ~74% de-vigged	
Market	Line (Jun 26)	Source	Interpretation		
Moneyline	NZL +1400 / Draw +650 / BEL –575	DraftKings, FanDuel, bet365	Heavy favorite; draw catastrophic for Belgium advancement.		
Asian Handicap	Belgium –2.5 @ +115 to +120	DraftKings, Bettors Insider	Market expects multi-goal margin possible.		
Total Goals	3.5 — Under –145 / Over +115	WinnersAndWhiners	Split market; Belgium scoring drought vs Iran noted.		
Both Teams to Score	Yes favored	WinnersAndWhiners	NZ scored in both games; Belgium blank once.		
Model xG	NZL 0.62 — BEL 2.01	Bracket Research	Aligns with 0-2 or 1-2 score thesis.		
Quick Guide: American –575 means wager \$575 to win \$100. +1400 means \$100 wins \$1,400. Asian Handicap –2.5 wins if Belgium win by 3+ goals; push/half-loss rules vary by book at exactly 2-goal margin. Over 2.5 needs 3+ total goals. Correct Score 2-0 pays only if exact final score matches.					

Risk Checklist

Belgium Finishing Risk

0 goals vs Iran despite 23 shots. A 1-0 win loses -2.5 core entirely.

Concentration Risk

60% on -2.5 means narrow Belgium win wipes core stake.

Parallel Group Match

Egypt vs Iran simultaneous — Belgium tactics may shift if Egypt lead early.

Maximum budget: \$100. Do not chase losses. If odds fall below minimum thresholds, skip the selection. Minors prohibited from sports wagering where applicable. This report is entertainment analysis, not investment advice.

Sources

- FIFA — New Zealand vs Belgium Match Centre (Match 64)
- ESPN — Live Score, Stats & Form
- Sporting News — Group G Standings (MD2)
- Bracket Research — Odds & Model (DraftKings -475)
- RotoWire — Multi-book Odds (Jun 26)
- Transfermarkt — New Zealand Squad & Values
- Transfermarkt — Belgium Squad & Values
- Petra — Referee Adham Makhadmeh Appointment
- Environment Canada — Vancouver Forecast (Jun 25)
- BC Place — Retractable Roof FAQ
- Sports Mole — Injuries & Predicted XIs
- Sportstar — Ngoy Red Card Explanation
- FIFA — New Zealand Squad Announcement
- AP News — Belgium Squad (Courtois, Lukaku, De Bruyne)